

SENATE BILL 1725

By Hatcher

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 69,
Chapter 9, relative to the moorage of vessels.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 69, Chapter 9, Part 2, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) The operator of a recreational vessel shall not:

(1) Moor the vessel for more than fourteen (14) consecutive days at any one (1) place along the water's edge of a reservoir or at any place within one (1) mile of the water's edge;

(2) Establish temporary moorage within the limits of primary or secondary navigation channels of the Tennessee River system; or

(3) Place the mooring lines of the vessel in such a way as to block or hinder boating access to any part of a reservoir.

(b) A violation of subdivision (a)(1), (a)(2), or (a)(3) is a Class C misdemeanor.

(c) It is not a violation of subdivision (a)(1) if the recreational vessel has been issued a permit for permanent or extended mooring pursuant to federal law.

(d) As used in this section:

(1) "Moor" means the act of making fast or securing a recreational vessel with lines or anchors;

(2) "Recreational vessel" means a vessel manufactured or used primarily for noncommercial use or leased, rented, or chartered to another for the latter's noncommercial use;

(3) "Reservoir" means a basin that contains or will contain the water impounded by a dam and that is under the management and control of a federal agency; and

(4) "Tennessee River system" means any part of the Tennessee River or any of the Tennessee River's tributaries that are under the management and control of a federal agency.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.